For this assignment, you will write up as much material as possible in class. At the end of class, you can take a picture of it with your phone before I collect it, scan it, and email it to you that evening. You can work on (rearrange, refine) this in-class material on your own as homework, but you should try to stay as close as you can to the in-class material you wrote. Do not use LLMs or any other so-called "artificial intelligence": this is a writing class, after all! Sometime before the deadline, turn in a PDF or DOC file *both* (1) via Canvas, *and also* (2) to my email address (scm244@cornell.edu).

Deadline: Tuesday November 10th 10pm

Writing Assignment #3

Choose one of the following three collections of texts as representing a general topic to write on:

1. Julia Annas, "Living Happily" (chapter 8 of *Intelligent Virtue*)
   Robert Nozick, "The Experience Machine" (from *Anarchy, State, and Utopia*)
   Derek Parfit, "What Makes Someone's Life Go Best" (new, completely optional reading)
2. John Stuart Mill, "Utility of Religion" (from *Three Essays on Religion*)
   George Mavrodes, "Religion and the Queerness of Morality" (new, completely optional reading)
3. James Edwin Mahon, "Kant, Morality, and Hell"
   Immanuel Kant, *Groundwork of the Metaphysics of Morals*, sections I and II (new, completely optional reading)
   Euthyphro dilemma (let me know and I'll find you relevant texts)

In this collection, find a point you want to write about, brainstorm what people might say about it, and carry out the following tasks in a sequence of sections:

A. Clearly but succinctly explain the point. What exactly is it: an important but unsupported/controversial claim being made, an argument in support of some position, an argument against some position, a criticism of an argument, or what?
   - If it's an argument, clearly spell out how it goes. You can provide a numbered premise-conclusion reconstruction, or a well-written paragraph of ordinary prose.
   - If it's an unsupported/controversial claim, clearly explain what exactly the claim is and is not saying. Also explain why the claim is important, or at least important in the eyes of the author.

B. Make your own critical point about the point in the text:
   - This new critical point should not already be obviously and explicitly in the readings. It's fine if this a point you've heard other people make, but if it's from a specific person then you must provide some citation or acknowledgement.
   - If the original point is an argument, you can present a new objection to the argument. Be sure to explain how the objection works: is it challenging a specific premise, or challenging the support provided to a specific conclusion, or what?
   - Or if the original point is an unsupported/controversial claim, you can present a new argument against that claim. Or you can present a new argument in support of the claim, ideally something that strengthens the author's overall case.

C. Present a brief critical assessment of how someone might respond to this critical point:
   - Perhaps you think your critical point is conclusive. If so, try to explain the best options available for responding to this critical point, and why they don't work.
   - Or perhaps you think your critical point is inconclusive. If so, try to explain how it could be responded to, and anything interesting that can be learned from this back-and-forth.

In your submission, be sure to clearly state at the beginning which collection of texts you're using (1, 2, or 3), and to label sections A, B, and C.

Your submission should have between 1000 and 1500 words total